

Video Production

ANTH 2315 Religion and Modernity

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Fall 2026

Taught by Tiffany Cruz and Reba Dickson



Discussion

- Have you taken a video before? What did you consider when shooting the video?
- What video effects have you seen recently? How did they impact your perception of the content?



Workshop agenda

- Example
- Ideas/questions
- Vocab
- Interview Recording
- Video Production
- Editing Software

Slides, handouts, and data available at

<https://bit.ly/fa26-hersh-videoediting>



Example Video



What did you notice about the production of this video?
What do you think the steps were to make this video?

[Margaret \(Maggie\) Carlson,](#)
[Anthropology, Ethnographic](#)
[Project Video: Daoism](#)



Important questions

- What are you trying to communicate to your audience?
- What argument are you making?
- What media (videos, images, audio) do you need to communicate your message and support your argument?



Video Production Steps



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*Feel free to ask questions at any point
during the presentation!*

Steps

- 1) Draft a Script
- 2) Plan your Shots
- 3) Select the Location(s)
- 4) Develop the Schedule
- 5) Shoot
- 6) Edit Video

<https://invideo.io/blog/how-to-make-a-video/>



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Script

- What you want to communicate
- Speaking points (refer to assignment guidelines)
 - Important facts from library research
 - Description of fieldsite and fieldwork experiences
 - Your main insight

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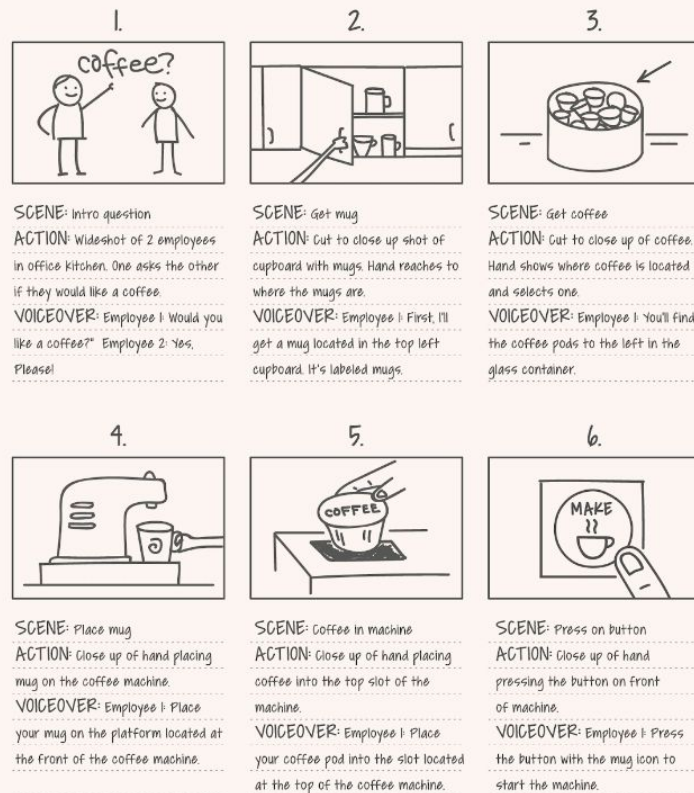
Storyboard or outline

- Once you know what you want to say, plan how you will say it “with video.”
- **Storyboard:** timeline of scene sketches
- **Outline:** bulleted list of the scene descriptions

<https://invideo.io/blog/how-to-make-a-video/>
<https://newbluefx.com/blog/video-editing-terms/>



TITLE: How To Use The Coffee Machine



What kinds of footage do you want?

- **A-roll:** main storyline footage
 - A “host” reciting a script
 - Interview participants engaged in discussion
- **B-roll:** “background” footage you can cut to any time
 - Close-ups of an object a subject is interacting with or discussing
 - Video of an activity or location a subject is discussing

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<https://newbluefx.com/blog/video-editing-terms/>

<https://www.adobe.com/creativecloud/video/discover/a-roll.html>



Make a shot list

- A **storyboard** or **outline** is a list of the shots and other information as it will appear in your video.
- A **shot list** is a planning document—it's your to-do list of each individual thing you will need to film.
 - For each shot, you'll need to plan a location and time to film it.



Location

- Permissions
 - Time constraints
 - Avoid filming people without consent
- Background noise
- Lighting
- Northeastern [production studios](#)

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Schedule

- Date and time for shoots
 - Location limitations
 - Room reservations
- Buffer/makeup days
 - Weather
 - Transportation
- Time for editing

<https://invideo.io/blog/how-to-make-a-video/>



Shoot

- Equipment
 - Phone camera or digital camera
 - Tripod
 - Fully charged
- Where to place camera
 - **The rule of thirds:** placing focal points at thirds in the image
- Review videos and images

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Edit video

- Integrate images and videos
- Adjust sound and voice over
- Background music
- Add titles or graphics

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Vocabulary review

- **Script:** the key information you want to convey, including specific words you want to use in narration (first document for video production)
- **Storyboard** or **outline:** two ways of planning out how your script will be connected to specific shots you'll film (second document you'll write)
- **Shot:** a single short video recording
- **Shot List:** a to-do list for all the shots you will need to create the video you've planned (third document you'll write)
- **The Rule of Thirds:** placing focal points at thirds in the image
- **A-roll:** main storyline footage
- **B-Roll:** “background” or secondary footage you can cut to any time



Avoiding Common Pitfalls



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Common pitfalls: image

- Avoid bright lights in your shot—they will make everything else look dark.
 - Outside, move so the sun is to the left or right of a person—not right in their face to make them squint, but not behind them.
 - Inside, check for a lamp or a bright window and consider moving so they are just outside the shot.
- Record “extra” footage at the beginning and end of each shot (this makes it easier to edit it later).



Common pitfalls: sound

- Background noise: Your microphone may hear a lot more than you do!
 - Record a “sound test” of “nothing” and listen to see if it’s acceptable.
- Turn off A/C units, consider closing windows, etc, if you can.
- Mute device notifications.



Free video editing software

- [Vimeo](#) (basic)
- [Lightworks](#)
- [VN Video Editor](#)
- [DaVinci Resolve](#) (advanced)
- [CapCut](#)

Next time, we will walk through how to edit in Capcut.



Discussion

- Questions about video production?
- Questions about how to get started?



Thank you!

—Developed by Tiffany Cruz and Emily Sandercock alongside Sara Morrell, Kasya O'Connor Grant, Carlos Arriaga Serrano, Halima Haruna, and Lawrence Evalyn

- For more information on the DITI, please see: <https://bit.ly/diti-about>
- Schedule an appointment with us! <https://bit.ly/diti-meeting>
- If you have any questions, contact us at: nulab.info@gmail.com
- We'd love your feedback! Please fill out a short survey here: <https://bit.ly/diti-feedback>



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